



Vroom Down Chock-a-Block Lanes With iWave Car PC

If you are worried about traffic jams, the car PC by iWave System Technologies is the perfect infotainment for you to enjoy the drive back home after a hard day of work

■ VANISHA JOSEPH

Listening to music on iPod or music player while driving through traffic-choked roads is a daily ordeal for most office goers. Some wish they could have finished their pending work, while others yearn for some entertainment to ease their stressed out nerves. To spice up the drive, iWave System Technologies has introduced a car computer—Intel's Atom-based ultra-mobile computing platform—which combines in-vehicle entertainment—music, movies and games, along with the Internet surfing facility.

"People spend 20-30 per cent of their time in traffic, which could otherwise be utilised for meetings, Internet surfing, email checking or entertainment. The car PC serves all these purposes, and will soon become a big name in the car infotainment technology," says M.A. Mohamed Saliya, MD, iWave System Technologies.

The innovation

Running on Windows (XP/CE6.0/Vista/7beta) operating system, iWave's car PC is a full-fledged PC within the car's headrest. "A 17.8cm (7-inch) colour LED backlight display, with touch controls, has been built into the standard headrest, and customised for vehicular operations," adds Saliya.

The device has two USB 2.0 ports to enable users to plug-in broadband wireless Internet. It is equipped with a 2-megapixel camera with recording facility, allowing passengers to use the video call facility. It also has an in-built GPS for navigation and mapping.

Sleek shape

As the car PC is fitted within the car headrest, it uses Q7 Atom CPU module motherboard, which gives it a complete functionality. "A motherboard is usually more than 25 cm in size. However, the Q7 Atom CPU module shrinks the size of the product to smaller than 7.6

cm. This module is apt for mobile and battery-powered applications and could be easily integrated for hand-held and ultra-mobile computing applications like the car PC. The module also provides a rich set of high and low-speed interfaces," says R. Immanuel, project lead, iW-Rainbow G6 (the unit dealing with Atom-based solutions), iWave System Technologies.

Power efficiency

iWave's car PC consumes nearly one-fifth of the power needed by a laptop. "Against standard laptops that consume about 60 watts of power, we reduced the device's power consumption to 10 watts by using a low-power 1.1/1.6 GHz Intel Atom processor and adopting certain power management techniques," says Immanuel.

Storage capacity

The device also addresses the storage issue usually faced by small-sized PCs. "With smaller gadgets, the data storage